



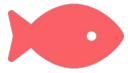
PHISHING AWARENESS

Learn to Identify and Prevent Phishing Attacks

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| What is Phishing?



Phishing is a cyber attack where criminals pretend to be legitimate organizations to steal your sensitive information.

Think of it as digital 'fishing' - attackers use fake bait (emails, websites) to catch victims.



Attacker's Goal:

- Steal passwords and login credentials
- Obtain credit card and banking information
- Install malware or viruses on devices
- Steal personal and financial data

Why Should You Care?



90%

of data breaches
start with phishing

1 in 4

people click on
phishing emails

\$14.8M

average loss from
phishing attacks

75%

of organizations
faced phishing in 2023

Source: Cybersecurity Industry Reports 2023-2024

| Types of Phishing Attacks



Email Phishing

Fake emails from 'banks', 'Amazon', or trusted companies



Smishing (SMS)

Fraudulent text messages asking for personal info



Vishing (Voice)

Scam phone calls pretending to be legitimate organizations



Spear Phishing

Targeted attacks on specific individuals or companies



Whaling

High-value attacks targeting CEOs and executives

Real Example: Fake PayPal Email



From: security@paypa1-verify.com
Subject: Your Account Has Been Suspended!

Dear User,

We noticed suspicious activity on your account. Click here immediately to verify your account or it will be permanently closed within 24 hours.



Red Flags:

- ✗ Wrong email domain (paypa1 not paypal - notice the '1')
- ✗ Generic greeting ('Dear User' instead of your name)
- ✗ Creates urgency and fear ('24 hours or account closed')
- ✗ Asks to click suspicious link without proper verification

| How to Identify Phishing

- ✓ Check sender's email address carefully (look for misspellings)
- ✓ Look for spelling and grammar errors in the message
- ✓ Hover over links before clicking (don't click!)
- ✓ Watch for urgent or threatening language
- ✓ Be suspicious of unexpected attachments
- ✓ Verify requests through official channels (call directly)



Golden Rule: When in doubt, DON'T click! Verify through official channels.

| Real vs Fake Website



<https://www.amazon.com>

- ✓ Has padlock icon (🔒)
- ✓ Correct spelling
- ✓ HTTPS secure connection



<http://amazn-security.com>

- ✗ No padlock icon
- ✗ Misspelled domain (amazn)
- ✗ Asks for password immediately

🔑 Key Differences to Check:

1. URL spelling - One wrong letter can mean it's fake
2. Security indicators - Look for 🔒 padlock and HTTPS
3. Domain extension - Real companies use .com, not .net or weird extensions

Social Engineering Tactics

Attackers manipulate emotions to bypass your logic



Authority

'This is the IRS, you owe taxes immediately!'



Urgency

'Act now or lose your account in 1 hour!'



Fear

'Your computer has 27 viruses! Click to remove!'



Curiosity

'You won a \$500 Amazon gift card! Claim now!'



Greed

'Invest \$100, make \$10,000 in one week!'

How to Protect Yourself



- 1 Verify sender before clicking anything - check email address carefully
- 2 Type URLs directly instead of clicking links in emails
- 3 Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all accounts
- 4 Keep software and antivirus programs updated regularly
- 5 Use strong, unique passwords for each account
- 6 Report suspicious emails to your IT department
- 7 Educate yourself regularly about new phishing tactics



Your awareness is your best defense against phishing!

What If You Clicked?



Don't panic! Follow these steps immediately:

- 1** Disconnect from internet immediately to prevent further damage
- 2** Change your passwords from another secure device
- 3** Contact your bank if you shared any financial information
- 4** Run a full antivirus and malware scan on your device
- 5** Report the incident to your IT department or security team
- 6** Monitor your accounts for suspicious or unauthorized activity



Act fast but don't panic - quick action can minimize damage!



Test Your Knowledge!

Interactive Phishing Awareness Quiz

The following slides contain quiz questions to test what you've learned.

Question 1

You receive an email from 'support@microsoft.com' asking you to verify your account. What should you do?

A) Click the link immediately

B) Reply with your password

C) Delete it - it's fake (Microsoft uses microsoft.com) ✓

D) Forward to friends

Question 2

Which of these is a red flag in an email?

A) Personalized greeting with your name

B) 'URGENT: Act within 24 hours or account closes!' ✓

C) Professional formatting and company logo

D) Contact information at the bottom

Question 3

Your boss emails asking for gift cards urgently. The email looks legitimate. What do you do?

A) Buy gift cards immediately - boss needs them!

B) Call or message your boss directly to verify ✓

C) Reply to the email asking for more details

D) Ignore it completely



Key Takeaways

- Phishing is everywhere - stay alert and vigilant
- Always verify before clicking any links or attachments
- Trust your instincts - if it feels wrong, it probably is
- Security is everyone's responsibility - report suspicious activity

Stay Safe Online!



Questions?